



Frozen Bureau Pulls — Guide

What to know and do when a borrower has frozen credit bureaus.

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How Bureau Freezes Work

A credit freeze (also called a security freeze) is placed by the borrower directly with each credit bureau — Experian, TransUnion, and Equifax. It can be managed through each bureau's app, website, or by phone.

A freeze may block one, two, or all three bureaus, depending on where the borrower placed it. Each bureau must be unfrozen individually. A freeze at one bureau does not affect the others.

Key Rules

■ No Scores on a Frozen Bureau

If a pull is attempted while any bureau is still frozen, the affected bureau may not return data or scores.

■ Each Repull Incurs a Charge

Every repull on a frozen file results in a charge from the bureau. Do not repull until you have confirmed the borrower has fully lifted the freeze at all affected bureaus.

■ Recommended Wait Time

Online or phone freeze lift requests may process quickly, but timing can vary. We recommend waiting at least 30 minutes after the borrower confirms the freeze is lifted before repulling — to help avoid a failed pull and an unnecessary charge.

Steps to Resolve a Frozen Bureau File

- 1 Notify the borrower that their credit file is frozen.
- 2 Have the borrower lift the freeze on all affected bureaus (Experian, TransUnion, and/or Equifax) through each bureau's app, website, or by phone.
- 3 Confirm with the borrower that all affected bureaus have been unfrozen.
- 4 Wait at least 30 minutes after the borrower confirms the freeze is lifted.
- 5 Click Reorder Frozen/Locked Files to repull the report.

Quick Reference

Topic	Detail
Where to unfreeze	Each bureau's official app, website, or phone — confirm current options at each bureau's official website
Bureaus that may be frozen	Experian, TransUnion, Equifax (each individually)
Scores generated if frozen?	The affected bureau may not return data or scores — freeze must be fully lifted first
Bureau-stated unfreeze time	May process quickly, but timing can vary
Recommended wait time	30 minutes minimum before repulling

Note: Contact methods and phone numbers may change. Borrowers should confirm freeze-lift options directly through each bureau's official website.

Before You Repull Checklist

- Borrower confirmed all frozen bureaus were lifted
- Borrower confirmed correct personal information is on file
- Waited the recommended time before repulling
- Contacted ISC Credit if unsure about repull status

Borrower confirmed the freeze was lifted but the report still will not pull? Contact ISC Credit at (800) 290-2801 before attempting multiple repulls.

This guide is for general workflow education only. Requirements may vary by lender, investor, AUS, credit bureau, account setup, and applicable law. ISC Credit does not make underwriting or credit approval decisions. Clients should follow their own company policies, investor guidelines, and compliance requirements.

Bureau Contact Information

DIRECT LINE

- **Equifax**
800-203-7843
- **Experian**
888-397-3742
- **TransUnion**
800-916-8800

WEBSITE TO MANAGE FREEZES

- **Equifax**
<https://www.equifax.com/personal/credit-report-services/credit-freeze/>
- **Experian**
<https://www.experian.com/freeze/center.html>
- **TransUnion**
<https://www.transunion.com/credit-freeze>